



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Tuesday, January 20, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 6:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 6 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmember Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

Councilmembers Excused: 1 – Councilmember Philip Lindholm.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Proclamation recognizing Chief Jim Sharp, West Pierce Fire and Rescue for his service to the community.

MAYOR PAUL BOCCHI PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING CHIEF JIM SHARP, WEST PIERCE FIRE AND RESCUE FOR HIS SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY. CHIEF PATRICK SMITH, LAKEWOOD POLICE DEPARTMENT PRESENTED A PLAQUE RECOGNIZING CHIEF SHARP FOR HIS SERVICE.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Camden Meyers and Tricia Parsons.

Ken Paulson, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns regarding traffic and speed limits in the area of Lochburn Lane.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke in opposition to the proposed semi-truck parking lot adjacent to Emerson Lake wetland in the Woodbrook neighborhood and in opposition to fee based mitigation in place of preservation.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, requested the City Council commit to equal enforcement of public right of way encroachments and address the environmental crisis on American Lake.

Kim Underwood, Lakewood resident, spoke about toxic blooms in American Lane and in support of a compliance review with a science-based management plan.

Lewis Cunningham, St. Francis Cabrini, expressed concerns about traffic and speed limits in the area of 108th Street.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about bureaucratic bias.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of January 5, 2026.

- B. Motion No. 2026-05

Approving the 2026 citizens advisory board, committee and commission work plans.

- C. Motion No. 2026-06

Approving the City Council liaisons to citizens' advisory boards, committees and commissions and representation on external boards and committees.

- D. Motion No. 2026-07

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Gunderson Law Firm for prosecution and related legal services.

- E. Motion No. 2026-08

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Washington State Department of Ecology to utilize grants funds to treat invasive milfoil on American Lake.

- F. Motion No. 2026-09

Authorizing the execution of a professional services agreement with Commonstreet Consulting, in the amount of \$88,859.01, for services related to the Custer Road Safety Improvement Project.

- G. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:
1. Public Safety Advisory Committee meeting minutes of October 1, 2025.
 2. Planning Commission meeting minutes of October 15, 2025.
 3. Lakewood's Promise Advisory Board meeting minutes of November 6, 2025.
 4. Planning Commission meeting minutes of November 19, 2025.
 5. Planning Commission meeting minutes of December 3, 2025.

Councilmember Talbo requested Item No. F, Motion No. 2026-09 be removed from the Consent Agenda.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT MOTION NO. 2026-09. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION

Review of Lakewood Municipal Code amendments related to the allowed locations of alcohol production and sales.

Planning Manager Tiffany Speir provided an overview of recommended amendments to the Lakewood Municipal Code related to alcohol sales and production which are in compliance with current state law and regulatory approaches. She shared that next steps will include a public hearing scheduled for the Council meeting of February 2nd followed by adoption on February 19th. Discussion ensued.

Review of 2024 Limited Tax General Obligation (LTGO) Bond Refund.

Deputy City Manager Tho Kraus shared that the bonds were issued in 2024 and the City has the opportunity refinance them to reduce debt service costs and save \$153,000 over the life. It is recommended that the City Council authorize refinancing of the 2024 Limited Tax General Obligation (LTGO) Bonds. Discussion ensued.

Review of 3rd Quarter (2025) Financial Report.

Deputy City Manager Tho Kraus provided an overview of activity in all funds through September 30, 2025. Discussion ensued.

Review of 112th Street – Farwest Drive to Holden Road Project.

Capital Projects Manager Troy Potswinski shared that the 112th Street from Farwest Drive to Holden Road is a Safe Routes to School project which includes bike lanes, street lightening, sidewalks and minor traffic improvements near Lake Louise Elementary School. He shared that the project is currently advertising for bids with a contract anticipated to come forward for City Council approval on February 17th. Discussion ensued.

Discussion then ensued regarding traffic impacts from the 112th Street between Gravelly Lake Drive and Bridgeport Way. Councilmember Talbo requested that the City Council consider road and transportation projects from a safety perspective and in support of ranking Comprehensive Transportation Improvement Plan (TIP) projects. Councilmember Pearson spoke about considering 108th Street for a site for future automated traffic safety cameras.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell confirmed that City Councilmembers are all available for a Retreat to be held on Saturday, April 18th.

He shared that the City is adding 30th Anniversary component to each of the events this year with a kickoff at the May 29th Streets Festival and a larger event at SummerFEST. After discussion, the City Council recommended considering a physical and digital time capsule with past and current relics, tree planting, purchasing art for display at city hall, inviting prior elected officials as well as those involved in the cityhood campaign and the city's Sister City representatives.

He then requested that the City Council identify their availability on February 18th, 19th or 23rd to travel to Olympia to meet with State Legislators.

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Lauricella requested that the city review data regarding potential revenues related to the sales of cannabis in the city.

Councilmember Talbo shared that she supports an update on data related to sale of cannabis in the city.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the South Sound 911 Board meeting where they will be selecting a new Board Chair. He requested donations from Councilmembers towards the Lakewood Lions Youth scholarship. He spoke about considering community impact related to cannabis sales and he spoke about bills under review by the State Legislature.

Deputy Mayor Belle thanked those who provided public comments this evening and encouraged residents to reach out to the City to provide accurate information. She is also in support of data regarding cannabis sales and shared that she will attend the Association of Washington Cities (AWC) City Action Days this week.

Mayor Bocchi shared that he signed on to a letter of opposition regarding House Bill 2489, Unhoused Bill of Rights.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:03 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK